



▲ THE LOFOTEN ISLANDS RISING FROM THE GREENISH BLUE WATERS OF THE NAPPSTRAUMEN STRAIT

The Bahia Coastline

Location Bahia state coast, eastern Brazil

Stretching for about 620 miles (1,000km), this is the longest coastline in Brazil, featuring sandy beaches, river estuaries, small deltas, large bays, and coral reefs. Much of the Bahia coast is backed by expanses of Atlantic forest. There are fringing reefs at Pintaunas, Praia do Forte, and Itacimirim. Just south of the idyllic sandy bay at Trancoso is Monte Pascoal National Park, an old-growth Atlantic forest with a population of the endangered red-browed Amazon parrot, along with scarce mammals such as jaguar, cougar, and giant armadillo.

Other coasts, islands, and reefs in Central and South America

- **Cape Horn** » p.117
- **Chilean Fjordland** » p.116
- **The Galápagos Islands** » pp.320-21
- **The Great Blue Hole** » p.114-15
- **Lençóis Maranhenses** » p.116

Europe

The Lofoten Islands

Location Nordland region, northern Norway

This archipelago of five large islands and many small ones stretches for 100 miles (160km), and is characterized by steep-sided

mountains of ancient metamorphic gneiss and quartzite, rising up from the sea. The landscape of deep valleys and fjords was crafted by the action of glaciers. The Rost Reef, discovered in 2002, is the world’s largest deepwater coral reef. Built by Lophelia corals, it is 22 miles (35km) long. One of the world’s most powerful tidal eddies occurs close to the island of Mosken.

The North Jutland Dunes

Location Between Frederikshavn and Skagen, northern Denmark

For centuries, windblown sand caused problems for farmers in the Skagen area. Persistent southwesterly winds shifted dunes onto farmland and even buried

buildings. Most of the dunes have been stabilized by the planting of vegetation, but one—the Rabjerg Mile—has been left unrestrained. Up to 130 ft (40m) high and containing an estimated 140 million cubic feet (4 million cubic meters) of sand, this huge dune migrates up to 60 ft (18m) northeast every year. It began its movement from the coast of Skagerrak, a strait separating Denmark from southwest Sweden, 300 years ago.

The Devon Ria Coast

Location Plymouth and Exmouth, Devon, UK

The coast of south Devon has several drowned valleys, or rias, partially submerged by a rise in sea level of up to 80 ft (25m)